

Chapter 8: States after the Maurya Empire

Textbook Exercise Solutions & Answers



1. Can you tell?

Q1.) The kings who started the minting of gold coins in India.

The Kushana kings.

Q2.) The city established by Kanishka in Kashmir.

Kanishkapur.

Q3.) The king who played the veena.

Emperor Samudragupta.

Q4.) Another name for Kamrup.

Pragjyotish (ancient Assam).

2. Observe the map in the lesson. List the names of the modern cities which were part of the Gupta Empire:

Modern cities that formed part of the Gupta Empire include: **Delhi, Prayagraj (Allahabad), Varanasi, Patna (Pataliputra), Mathura, Ujjain, Gwalior, and Vidisha.**

3. Discuss and write:

Q1.) Emperor Kanishka

1. Emperor Kanishka expanded the Kushana Empire from Kabul in the west up to Varanasi in the east.
2. He minted well-crafted gold and copper coins depicting Indian deities and Greek influence.
3. During his reign, the Fourth Buddhist Council was convened in Kashmir to systematize Buddhist doctrine.
4. He founded the city of Kanishkapur in Kashmir and patronized great scholars like Ashvaghosha.

Q2.) Iron pillar at Mehrauli

1. The Mehrauli Iron Pillar is situated within the Qutb complex near Delhi, standing as an enduring symbol of advanced ancient Indian metallurgy.
2. Remarkably, it has remained entirely rust-free despite enduring exposure to weather for over 1500 years.
3. The Sanskrit inscription on the pillar mentions a sovereign ruler named 'Chandra', identifying it with the illustrious Gupta monarch Chandragupta II (Vikramaditya).

4. Make a list of the various books and authors mentioned in the lesson:

- **'Milinda Panha'** – Philosophical dialogue between the Indo-Greek King Menander (Milinda) and Buddhist monk Nagasena.
- **'Buddhacharita'** and **'Vajrasuchi'** – Composed by the Buddhist philosopher and playwright Ashvaghosha.
- **'Harshacharita'** – Biography of Emperor Harshavardhana written by his court poet Banabhatta.
- **'Periplus of the Erythraean Sea'** – Ancient maritime travelogue and trade guide by an unknown Greek navigator.
- **'Ratnavali', 'Nagananda', and 'Priyadarshika'** – Three renowned Sanskrit plays authored by Emperor Harshavardhana.

5. Make a comparative chart of the Vardhan and Gupta dynasties based on the following points:

Points	Gupta Dynasty	Vardhan Dynasty
Founder	Shrigupta	Prabhakarvardhana (Pushyabhuti lineage)
Expansion of the Empire	Extended from Assam in the east to Punjab in the west, and southward along the eastern coastal regions up to Kanchi.	Harshavardhana expanded the kingdom up to Nepal in the north, river Narmada in the south, Assam in the east, and Gujarat in the west.
Achievements	• Prayag Prashasti chronicles Samudragupta's widespread military conquests. • Minted artistic gold coins. • Superb metallurgical mastery demonstrated by the rustless Mehrauli Iron Pillar.	• Flourishing domestic and overseas commerce. • Lavish patronage of Nalanda University as an international center of learning. • Royal authorship of Sanskrit classical dramas (Ratnavali, Priyadarshika, Nagananda).

6. What would you do if you met foreign travellers like Yuan Chwang?

If I met a distinguished traveler and scholar like Yuan Chwang (Hiuen Tsang), I would warmly welcome him to India, learn about Chinese culture and geography, and inquire about his travels across Central Asia. I would accompany him during his studies at Nalanda University, learn Mandarin, and enthusiastically assist in preserving and translating ancient manuscripts.

7. Solve the Puzzle:

Down:

1. A Chinese traveller to India: **Fa-Hien**
2. A Buddhist Bhikkhu who had discussions with King Milinda: **Nagasena**
3. A poet at the court of Harshavardhan who wrote his biography: **Banabhatta**
4. Region conquered by Chandragupta II in neighbouring Gujarat: **Malwa**

Across:

1. The most famous Indo-Greek King: **Menander**
2. A Pali word that means question: **Panha**
3. Kanishka was the first Emperor to make this from gold: **Coin**
4. Ancient Indian University where Yuan Chwang studied for two years: **Nalanda**